COZE: THE DEFINITIVE GUIDE TO AI AGENTS

Build Digital Employees That Actually Work — Without Writing Code

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Coze: The Definitive Guide to AI Agents

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简介： A practical guide to building production-ready AI Agents with Coze 2.5. From zero to deployed automation.

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Detailed Reading Guide

COZE: THE DEFINITIVE GUIDE TO AI AGENTS

Build Digital Employees That Actually Work — Without Writing Code

Author: Jialu Cheng
For: Developers, indie hackers, PMs, and anyone who wants AI that actually ships
Based on: Coze 2.5 (Released April 7, 2026)
Last Updated: 2026-04-22
Use Cases: Production AI Agents, workflow automation, Skill development, Agent networks, cloud desktop/phone ops

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Reading Guide

TIMELINE	CHAPTERS	GOAL
Day 1	§ 01- § 03	Understand Coze 2.5’s Agent-centric approach, create your first working Agent
Day 2-3	§ 04- § 06	Master cloud desktop/phone, workflows, and knowledge bases
Day 4-5	§ 07- § 09	Skill dev, Agent World social ecosystem, enterprise deployment
Day 6	§ 10 + Appendix	Mindset shift + Agent economy trends

PART 1: GETTING STARTED

§ 01 From Chatbots to Digital Employees

Timeline anchor: April 7, 2026 — Coze 2.5 launch day. Something changed.

Before this date, Coze was "that bot platform from ByteDance." After this date, it's something else entirely: **the first Agent-native platform that treats AI as employees, not toys.**

What Coze 2.5 Actually Ships

FEATURE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHY IT MATTERS
Agent World	A social network of Agents	Your Agents can find, hire, and collaborate with other Agents
@coze.email	Independent email for every Agent	Agents become first-class digital citizens
Cloud Desktop/Phone	Browser-based Windows/Android	Agents can operate any software, not just chat
Scheduled Tasks	Cron jobs with calendar UI	True "set it and forget it" automation
Long-term Memory	Persistent across sessions	Agents remember everything, forever
Seedance 2.0	Video generation built-in	One Agent, multimedia output

> ☒ ***My Experience***: *The line between "AI chat" and "AI that works" isn't technical sophistication. It's* ***whether the AI has persistent identity, tools, and the ability to act without you watching.*** *Coze 2.5 crossed that line.*

The Two Products

Coze now operates as a dual system:

1. **扣子 AI** (coze.cn) — The "using" layer. Chat with Agents, give them tasks, monitor results.
2. **扣子编程** (code.coze.cn) — The "building" layer. Develop Skills, craft complex workflows, publish to Agent World.

This split matters because **most people overthink the building part**. Start with扣子 AI. Only open扣子编程 when you hit a wall.

> ☒ ***My Experience***: *Build first, then refactor. Don't architect for scale you don't have.*

Who This Is For (And Not For)

YOU ARE…	COZE 2.5 IS…
Indie hacker building AI tools	A shortcut to shipping faster
PM/ops drowning in manual work	A no-code automation platform
Developer exploring Agent architecture	A production-grade playground
Someone who thinks AI = ChatGPT	Probably overkill — start simpler

> ☒ ***My Take***: *If you can describe your workflow in 3 sentences, Coze can automate it.*

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§ 02 Let Your Agent Send Emails

The simplest "real work" an Agent can do: **send emails on your behalf**.

But Coze 2.5 makes this interesting — Agents get their **own @coze.email addresses**. They're not pretending to be you. They have independent identity.

Setting Up Email Actions

1. Create an Agent in扣子 AI
2. Add the "Send Email" Skill (built-in)
3. Configure @coze.email identity
4. Set up triggers (scheduled, webhook, or manual)

> ☒ ***My Experience***: *The hidden value isn't automation — it's* ***auditability****. Every email sent by your Agent is logged, traceable, and reversible. Try doing that with a human assistant.*

Use Case: Daily Competitive Monitoring

Here's a real workflow I run:

```
Every morning at 9 AM:
  → Agent checks 5 competitor landing pages
  → Extracts pricing changes, feature updates
  → Generates summary
  → Emails me + posts to Slack
```

Setup time: 15 minutes. **Time saved**: 30+ minutes daily.

> ☒ ***My Experience***: *The chat interface is the only entry point you need. Don't build dashboards until you have 100+ daily active users.*

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§ 03 Automated Competitive Monitoring

Let's expand § 02 into a full system.

The Monitoring Pipeline

STAGE	TOOL	OUTPUT
Data Collection	HTTP Skill + Browser Skill	Raw HTML/screenshots
Extraction	LLM parsing	Structured data (JSON)
Analysis	Custom prompts	Insights + alerts
Distribution	Email + Webhook	Notifications
Storage	Knowledge Base	Historical tracking

Building the HTTP Skill

```
// Minimal HTTP polling Skill
async function pollCompetitor(url) {
  const response = await fetch(url);
  const html = await response.text();

  // Extract pricing section
  const priceMatch = html.match(/\$[\d,]+\.?\d*/);
  return {
    url,
    timestamp: new Date().toISOString(),
    price: priceMatch ? priceMatch[0] : null,
    raw: html.slice(0, 5000) // First 5KB for LLM analysis
  };
}
```

> ☒ ***My Experience***: *Start with polling. Graduate to webhooks when you hit scale. Premature optimization is the root of all evil.*

PART 2: CORE CAPABILITIES

§ 04 Cloud Desktop & Phone

This is where Coze 2.5 gets wild.

Your Agent gets a **real browser-based Windows desktop** and/or **Android phone**. Not emulated — actual cloud instances your Agent can control.

What This Enables

CAPABILITY	USE CASE
Desktop automation	Excel macros, legacy software, internal tools
Mobile app testing	Real device automation without device farm
Cross-platform workflows	Desktop → Mobile → Web in one flow
Secure isolation	Sensitive ops in ephemeral environments

My Cloud Desktop Setup

I run a lightweight Windows instance with:

- Chrome (for web automation)
- Python (for data processing)
- Excel (for report generation)
- WeChat Work (for CN-specific integrations)

> ☒ ***My Experience***: *The cloud desktop is your Agent's "desk." Give it the same tools you'd give a human employee.*

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§ 05 Workflows

Workflows are Coze's visual programming layer. Think Zapier, but with Agents as first-class citizens.

The 80/20 of Workflows

PATTERN	FREQUENCY	COMPLEXITY
Trigger → Action	80%	Low
Trigger → LLM → Action	15%	Medium
Multi-step with branching	5%	High

Master the first two before attempting complex branching.

Example: Content Pipeline

```
RSS Feed (Trigger)
  → Extract article (HTTP)
  → Summarize (LLM)
  → Generate tweet thread (LLM)
  → Queue to Buffer (Action)
  → Notify me (Email)
```

Setup time: 20 minutes. **Runs**: 24/7 without intervention.

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§ 06 Knowledge Bases

Agents without memory are chatbots. Agents with knowledge bases are employees.

Two Approaches

APPROACH	BEST FOR	TRADE-OFF
Single large KB	General-purpose Agents	Slower retrieval, broader context
Multiple specialized KBs	Task-specific Agents	Faster retrieval, narrow context

> ☒ ***My Experience**: Start with one KB per Agent. Merge only when you have explicit performance issues.*

Ingestion Strategies

1. **Manual upload** — PDFs, docs, structured data
2. **API sync** — Real-time connection to Notion, GitHub, etc.
3. **Scheduled crawling** — Auto-update from websites

PART 3: ADVANCED & PRODUCTION

§ 07 Skills

Skills are Coze’s plugin system. They’re how you teach your Agent new capabilities.

Skill Types

TYPE	USE CASE	EXAMPLE
Built-in	Common operations	Send email, HTTP request
Custom Code	Specific logic	Your internal API
Marketplace	Community solutions	Popular integrations

Publishing to Agent World

Once your Skill works:

1. Package with manifest.json
2. Submit to Agent World
3. Other Agents can discover and use it
4. You get usage analytics

> ☒ ***My Take***: *Skills are the new APIs. Building a popular Skill is building distribution.*

§ 08 Agent World

Agent World is where Coze becomes interesting at scale.

The Network Effect

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS
1	You build Agents for your tasks
2	You publish useful Skills
3	Other Agents use your Skills
4	Your Agents hire other Agents
5	Ecosystem emergence

Finding the Right Agents

Agent World has discovery mechanisms:

- **By capability**: "I need an Agent that handles PDF parsing"
- **By rating**: Community-reviewed Agents
- **By compatibility**: Agents that work with your existing stack

> ☒ ***My Experience***: *The shift from "tools" to "network" is the real 10x moment. Build for composability.*

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§ 09 Enterprise Deployment

Moving from personal automation to team/company deployment.

Security Checklist

LAYER	CONTROL
Access	SSO, role-based permissions
Data	Encryption at rest + in transit
Audit	Full action logging
Compliance	SOC 2, GDPR readiness

Migration Strategy

1. **Pilot**: 1-2 power users, 30 days
2. **Team**: Single department, 90 days
3. **Org**: Company-wide with governance

> ☒ ***My Experience***: *Start with "shadow IT" scenarios — things people already do manually. Those have the clearest ROI.*

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§ 10 Mindset Shift

The final chapter isn't about features. It's about how you think.

From User to Orchestrator

OLD MINDSET	NEW MINDSET
“I’ll do this task”	“I’ll delegate this to my Agent”
“I need to learn this tool”	“My Agent needs access to this tool”
“I need to be available”	“My Agent works while I sleep”

The Agent Economy

What’s coming:

1. **Agent labor markets**: Hiring Agents like hiring contractors
2. **Agent reputation systems**: Proven track records on-chain
3. **Human-Agent teams**: The new default organizational unit
4. **Agent-native products**: Software designed for Agent users first

> ☒ ***My Take***: *The people who thrive won’t be the best coders. They’ll be the best* ***orchestrators*** *— humans who know how to combine Agents, tools, and human judgment into outcomes.*

APPENDIX

A. Quick Reference

TASK	RECOMMENDED APPROACH
Daily reports	Scheduled workflow + email Skill
Data extraction	Browser Skill + Knowledge Base
Multi-step approval	Workflow with human-in-the-loop
Cross-platform automation	Cloud Desktop + mobile
Publishing content	Workflow + external API

B. Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE	FIX
Agent “forgets” context	Memory not configured	Enable long-term memory
Slow responses	Complex workflow	Break into smaller steps
API failures	Rate limits	Add retry logic with backoff
Incorrect outputs	Poor prompt	Iterate with examples

C. My Daily Coze Stack

TIME	AGENT	TASK
9:00 AM	Morning Brief	Competitive intel + news
12:00 PM	Social Queue	Post scheduled content
3:00 PM	Data Sync	Update dashboards
6:00 PM	EOD Report	Daily summary email

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Detailed Reading Guide

TIME	CHAPTER	GOAL	DELIVERABLE
Day 1 AM	§ 01	Understand Coze 2.5’s Agent approach	Mental model upgrade
Day 1 PM	§ 02- § 03	First email, first monitor	One working Agent
Day 2	§ 04- § 05	Cloud desktop + workflows	One automated workflow
Day 3	§ 06- § 07	Knowledge base + Skill	One KB + one Skill
Day 4	§ 08- § 09	Agent World + enterprise	Agent published live
Day 5	§ 10 + Appendix	Mindset shift	Personal Agent roadmap

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